

Project 1 Description + Design Rationale

Visualization title: Whole Foods still stocks many ultra-processed foods, but its catalog is less dominated by them than Target's or Walmart's

Guiding question: If you compared the online grocery catalogs of Target, Walmart, and Whole Foods, how different would their exposure to ultra-processed food really be?

The chart answers that question in two steps. The stacked bars establish the big-picture takeaway first: ultra-processed foods dominate all three catalogs, but Whole Foods is meaningfully lower (67%) than Walmart (80%) and Target (84%). I used proportions instead of raw counts so that the comparison is fair even though the stores contribute different numbers of products to the dataset.

The dumbbell panel then narrows to categories carried by all three stores and highlights where Whole Foods differs most. Its largest gaps show up in categories such as baking and sausage / bacon, where Whole Foods carries noticeably fewer ultra-processed options. That second panel matters because the overall average could otherwise hide whether the difference is broad-based or concentrated in a few areas.

I designed the piece as an expository visualization rather than an exploratory dashboard. The headline states the conclusion up front, the left panel gives immediate context, and the right panel explains where the pattern comes from. Warm red is reserved for ultra-processed food so the dominant category is visually obvious, while store colors stay consistent in the annotations and category comparison panel. I also kept labels and footnotes inside the figure so the visualization can stand on its own.